



NRSP Safety Tip of The Week
By: Dovid Rosenberg



24 Hr Hotline
845-442-2900

Here are some bicycle safety tips for riding in your neighborhood:

1. Wear a helmet: It's crucial for protecting your head in case of a fall or collision.

2. Follow traffic rules: Obey stop signs, traffic lights, and lane markings.

3. Be visible: Wear bright or reflective clothing, especially at dawn, dusk, or night.

4. Use hand signals: Indicate turns and stops to alert drivers and pedestrians.

5. Stay alert: Watch for potholes, debris, and parked cars, and be mindful of pedestrians and pets.

6. Ride defensively: Anticipate the actions of drivers and pedestrians and be prepared to react.

By following these tips, you can reduce your risk of injury and enjoy a safe ride in your neighborhood!

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POMONA



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WESLEY HILLS



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84 Viola Road, Montebello (Yanky Reichman) This shul was sponsored in honor of רבי יצחק יוסף זצ"ל in memory of Reb Chaim Oizer Pretter A"H



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The Community Corner is a not-for-profit program aimed to bring younger members of our community into shul with excitement. We would love to hear any feedback or comments. Any comments should be emailed to Submissions@Ourcommunitycorner.com



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Community Service Announcement! Lets all have a safe Shabbos and wear a reflector when going outside!

BS"D

ISSUE #199

SEPTEMBER 26, 2025

FRIDAY, 4 TISHREI, 5785

COMMUNITY CORNER

PARSHAS

VAYELECH

וילך



SHABBOS STARTS: 6:28 PM (18 MINUTES)

SHABBOS ENDS: 7:34 PM (50 MINUTES)

TZAIS HAKOCHAVIM: 7:58 PM (72 MINUTES)

Editor-in-chief: Doni Stern
Made possible by contributing writers of Ohr Yaakov Shlomo- 43 Tamarack Lane, Pomona, NY.



STORY OF THE WEEK

By: Zechariah Lipitz



Once, on the evening before Yom Kippur, one of the chassidim of Rabbi Elimelech of Lizhensk asked his Rebbe to allow him to see how he, Rabbi Elimelech, observes the custom of kaparot.

"How I do kaparot?" repeated Rabbi Elimelech. "How do you do kaparot?"

"I am an ordinary Jew — I do what everyone else does. I hold the rooster in one hand, the prayer book in the other, and recite the text, 'This is my exchange, this is in my stead, this is my atonement...'"

"That's exactly what I do," said Rabbi Elimelech. "I take the rooster in one hand, the prayer book in the other, and recite the text. Actually, there might be a certain difference between your kaparot and mine: you probably make sure to use a white rooster, while to me it makes no difference: white, black, brown — a rooster's a rooster..."

But the chassid persisted that his Rebbe's kaparot was certainly no ordinary event. He had been coming to Lizhensk to pray with the Rebbe every Yom Kippur for more than twenty years now and had always wanted to observe his Rebbe at this most solemn moment.

"You want to see an extraordinary kaparot?" said Rabbi Elimelech. "Go observe how Moshe the tavern-keeper does kaparot. Now, there you'll see something far more inspiring than my own, ordinary kaparot."

The chassid located Moshe's tavern at a crossroads several miles outside of Lizhensk and asked to stay the night. "I'm sorry," said the tavern-keeper. "As you see, this is a small establishment, and we don't have any rooms to let. There's an inn a small distance further down the road."

"Please," begged the chassid, "I've been traveling all day, and I want to rest for a while. I don't need a room — I'll just curl up in a corner for a few hours and be on my way."

"O.K.," said Moshe. "We'll be closing up shortly, and then you can get some sleep."

After much shouting, cajoling and threatening, Moshe succeeded in herding his clientele of drunken peasants out the door. The chairs and tables were stacked in a corner, and the room, which also served as the tavern-keeper's living quarters, readied for the night. Midnight had long passed, and the hour of kaparot was approaching. The chassid, wrapped in his blanket under a table, feigned sleep, but kept watch in the darkened room, determined not to miss anything.

Before dawn, Moshe rose from his bed, washed his hands and recited the morning blessings. "Time for kaparot!" he called quietly to his wife, taking care not to wake his guest. "Yentel, please bring me the notebook — it's on the shelf above the cupboard."

Moshe sat himself on a small stool, lit a candle, and began reading from the notebook, unaware that his "sleeping" guest was wide awake and straining to hear every word. The notebook was a diary of all the misdeeds and transgressions the tavern-keeper had committed in the course of the year, the date, time and circumstance of each scrupulously noted. His "sins" were quite benign — a word of gossip one day, oversleeping the time for prayer on another, neglecting to give his daily coin to charity on a third — but by the time Moshe had read through the first few pages, his face was bathed in tears. For more than an hour Moshe read and wept, until the last page had been turned.

"Yentel," he now called to his wife, "bring me the second notebook."

This, too, was a diary — of all the troubles and misfortunes that had befallen him in the course of the year. On this day Moshe was beaten by a gang of peasants, on that day his child fell ill; once, in the dead of winter, the family had frozen for several nights for lack of firewood; another time their cow had died, and there was no milk until enough rubles had been saved to buy another.

When he had finished reading the second notebook, the tavern-keeper lifted his eyes heavenward and said: "So you see, dear Father in Heaven, I have sinned against You. Last year I repented and promised to fulfill Your commandments, but I repeatedly succumbed to my evil inclination. But last year I also prayed and begged You for a year of health and prosperity, and I trusted in You that it would indeed be this way.

"Dear Father, today is the eve of Yom Kippur, when everyone forgives and is forgiven. Let us put the past behind us. I'll accept my troubles as atonement for my sins, and You, in Your great mercy, shall do the same."

Moshe took the two notebooks in his hands, raised them aloft, circled them three times above his head, and said: "This is my exchange, this is in my stead, this is my atonement." He then threw them into the fireplace, where the smoldering coals soon turned the tear-stained pages to ashes.

PARSHA QUESTION

By: The Rabbi

Which body of water was Moshe told he would not cross?

Answer to last weeks parsha question:

Q. What two humble professions are singled out in the second pusik of this parsha?

A. Watercarrier and woodchopper.

MEGA VORT

By: Yoel Megadesh



Yom Kippur.

The Torah describes the 5 things we are not allowed to do (don't eat, wear shoes etc.) by saying "וּנְשִׂיתֶיכוֹם אֶת נַפְשֵׁיכֶם". This translates as "you shall afflict yourselves". The question is, why isn't it described as a negative (לא), like "don't eat" as opposed to "you shall afflict" which is a positive action (עשה)?

The answer is that there are 365 days in the year and Hashem gave us 365 negative commandments to combat yetzer hara every day of the year. On Yom Kippur however, the yetzer hara has no power (the gematria of תשון is 364, because he has power over 364 days, but not Yom Kippur). Since the yetzer hara has no power over Yom Kippur, the commandments of the day did not have to be described in a negative way (לא) since we don't need to fight him. (Vilna Gaon)

STATE OF THE WEEK

By: Ariella Isaacs



Pennsylvania

Year Formed: 1787 (2nd state)

Capital: Harrisburg

State Flower: Mountain Laurel

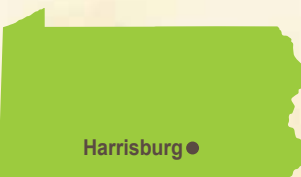
State Bird: Ruffed Grouse

Population: ~13.1M

State Motto: Virtue, Liberty, and Independence

Must-Visit Place: The Liberty Bell

Fun Fact: The first piano in America was constructed in Philadelphia in 1775.



Harrisburg





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From 26 September onwards, notices written in Russian, German and Ukrainian were posted around the city of Kiev, ordering the city's Jewish population to gather at Babi Yar. Babi Yar is a ravine located on the outskirts of Kiev, once home to one of the city's many Jewish cemeteries. The notice read as follows:

Jewish people were led to believe that, by gathering at the ravine at the ordered time, they would be resettled elsewhere in the country and taken to safety. Instead, they were murdered in one of the single deadliest events of the Holocaust.

The killings were led by the Einsatzkommando, a sub-group of the Nazi Einsatzgruppen which was responsible for the systematic murder of Jews, communists, Sinti and Roma in the German invasion of the Soviet Union. The Einsatzkommando were supported by the auxiliary police forces and local supporters of the Nazi regime. While estimates of the number of Jews killed at Babi Yar vary, according to reports by the Einsatzgruppe to headquarters, 33,771 Jews were massacred in two days. Over the course of the occupation, it is estimated that between 900,000 and 1.6 million Ukrainian Jews were murdered.

After the massacre, the site at Babi Yar continued to be used by the Nazis for mass executions of Jews, Soviet officials, prisoners of war and other victims of Nazi persecution. As the Red Army began to make advances through German-occupied territory, the Nazis sought to hide evidence of the massacres by exhuming the bodies, destroying any remaining traces of those who were murdered. The Red Army liberated Kiev on 6 November 1943.

Do you love to tell stories, share interesting facts, or solve riddles?

Check out these cool column ideas where you can share your creativity:

-  **Simoche Corner** – Celebrate the happy moments in our community!
-  **Famous Jewish Inventors** – Discover and write about the incredible inventions that have shaped our world.
-  **Riddles** – Got a knack for tricky riddles? Challenge our readers with your best puzzles!
-  **Did You Know?** – Share fun and surprising facts that will wow everyone!
-  **Poem of the Week** – Showcase your poetry and inspire others with your words.
-  **Parsha Snapshot** – Summarize the weekly Torah portion in your own unique style.
-  **Mitzvah of the Week** – Highlight acts of kindness and good deeds that make a difference.
-  **Nobel Prize Winners** – Write about the Jewish Nobel laureates who have changed the world with their ideas.
-  **Continuous Story** – Start a story and let our readers help you finish it, one week at a time!
-  **World Events** – Keep everyone informed about important happenings around the globe.

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**Let's make our newsletter
the best it can be together!**



It answers that there is reward for just coming! However, if we look, it seems that the Torah is telling us another profound reason to bring the entire family. The pesukim tell us we do this so we hear, learn and fear G-d. Yet when it then says bring the children, it states it slightly differently. Bring them so that they may hear and LEARN TO FEAR. Why the change in language?

The Torah is hinting at what the Gemara says. Children cannot understand the chain and as such they are not capable of hearing the words of G-d in Torah, then learning those words and finally creating Yiras Hashem as a benefit. No, the children will hear, just the words even when not understood will penetrate and then the children will learn to fear Hashem Yisbarach.

The Gemara is replete with examples of holy mothers that brought the young child to the Bais Medrash to just hear Torah even though they were too young to understand. Our environment is as important as our genetics! We join with friends and family, with yeshivas, shuls and many organizations. All these contacts give us opportunities to grow or shrink in spirituality. The Torah is teaching us a lesson in life. The adult population coming to Hakhel, will be enjoying the spirituality of the holy city of Yerushalayim, the holiness of the Har Habayis, the Kohanim, the Avoda , of course the King and all that comes with it. The renewal and revival of religious observance once every 7 years is built into our Torah system to reflect the calendar that does this for us as a holy people even though we do not have a temple. We will listen, we will learn, and we will fear G-d. The children, they too will listen, they will learn to fear G-d one day, as they grow; those environmental settings of holiness will emerge from the memories of these children. Our Torah, G-d given, is all intelligent, and programs for us the best environmental and experiential occurrences we may encounter so that we may choose bracha and true life!

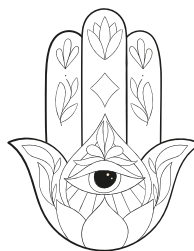
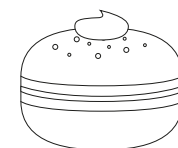
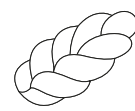
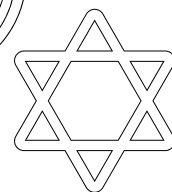
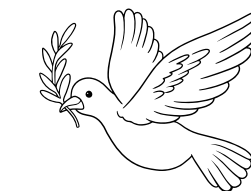
Master of gliding. With a fur-covered membrane from its face to its tail, the colugo is the most skilled gliding mammal, able to soar up to 200 feet between trees with impressive aerial control.

Not a lemur! Despite its nickname "flying lemur," the colugo isn't a lemur. Genetic evidence shows it is actually the closest living non-primate relative to primates.

A built-in baby pouch. Female colugos use their gliding membrane to create a temporary, warm pouch for their newborns. Much like a marsupial, the mother carries her underdeveloped baby in this pouch for months after birth.



CROSSWORD



Down

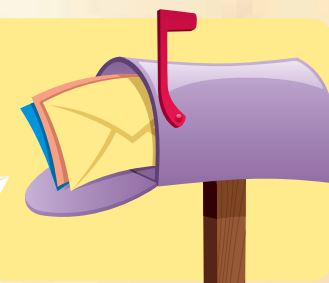
2. Spinning top used during a holiday in Kislev.
3. Symbolically, in Jewish tradition, this substance represents purity, holiness, and the enlightenment of God.
7. Central text of Judaism.
8. Site where Bar and Bat Mitzvahs often occur.
10. Jewish blessing that officially starts the Shabbat and holiday feasts.
11. Jewish holiday commemorating the Maccabees' victory
12. Terah's son who was called to journey from Ur to Canaan.
13. A holy day observed with fasting, prayer and reflection in Judaism.
14. Biblical character whose name means to laugh.
17. Used in the ritual of Kiddush on Friday night.
20. On Rosh HaShana you might have a round shape of this bread
21. Yiddish term used to describe chocolate or real money given at Hanukkah.
23. This religion's followers await the coming of the Messiah.
26. Ram's horn used in Jewish religious services.

Across

1. The five sons of Mattathias who led an uprising in Judea.
4. Inspiring event that is believed to have divine intervention.
4. A religious voyage to Jerusalem embarked on by Jews.
6. A small case holding Hebrew scriptures, affixed on doorposts.
9. Unwavering belief.
13. Religious cap worn in a synagogue by men.
15. The biblical book where you'll find the Ten Commandments.
16. Shawl worn in prayer that signifies understanding, observance, and respect for Jewish law.
18. In Judaism, the term for a commanded act or moral responsibility.
19. The biblical utopia.
22. Nine branched candelabra used in a Jewish Festival of Lights.
24. The holiday celebrating the rededication of the Temple goes on for this many days.
25. Where the covenant between God and Israelites was made.
27. The dwelling that recalls the period of Exodus.



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